



DIGITALAIKART PRESENTS

THE CA AI PRACTICE PLAYBOOK



60 Copy-Paste Prompts for Indian CA Firms,
Article Assistants and CA Students

GST monthly close under GST 2.0 and IMS - Notices and show-cause replies -
Income-tax Act 2025 workflows - Tax audit, Form 3CD and CARO 2020 -
Client communication - Practice management and training

Built on ICAI's own AI guidance - verified as of 30 September 2026

FIRST EDITION - SEPTEMBER 2026

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PART 0

Start Here

Most CA firms in India already use ChatGPT or Claude for something - an email, a checklist, a rough draft. Almost none of them use it well. The output cites sections that do not exist, mixes up the old Income-tax Act with the new one, forgets that GST returns changed twice since 2024, and occasionally walks client data out the door. This playbook fixes exactly that.

Inside are 60 prompts, written for Indian practice work, each one carrying its own guardrails so the AI drafts and you verify. None of them asks the AI for law. All of them ask for structure, drafts and checklists - the work an articulated assistant would do - and mark every place where you, the Chartered Accountant, must insert verified law before anything leaves the firm.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Practising CAs - sole practitioners and small firms drowning in monthly GST cycles, notices and review work.

Article assistants - produce partner-ready drafts on day one instead of blank-page first attempts.

CA students - learn how firms actually run AI-assisted workflows before you join one.

Industry finance and accounts teams - the GST close and audit chapters apply to in-house work too.

How to use it in the next ten minutes. Open Chapter 1, copy Prompt 03 (the vendor ITC chase sequence), replace the bracketed fields with an anonymised month, and send the draft. That is the whole method: copy, fill brackets, strip identifiers, run, verify every [VERIFY] marker, send.

What you will not find here. Legal advice, tax rates, section references stated as fact, or any claim that AI can replace professional judgement. Every prompt is built the other way: the AI gives you carpentry - structure, phrasing, checklists - and you supply the law from the bare Act, notifications and portal, where it belongs.

A note on verification. Everything this playbook states as fact about ICAI, the GST portal and the Income-tax Act, 2025 was verified on 30 September 2026 against official sources: ai.icai.org and icai.org, GSTN advisories and portal FAQs, the Income-tax Act, 2025 (as amended by the Finance Act, 2026) on incometaxindia.gov.in, and Indian Express reporting of 25 September 2026. Anything that can change - notifications, portal behaviour, course fees - is flagged in the text so you re-check it.

PART 1

What Your Institute Already Gives You Free

Before you pay for anything, know what ICAI has already built. The profession's own AI stack has grown fast, and the strongest Indian sign yet came on 26 June 2026, when ICAI signed an MoU with Sarvam AI, the Bengaluru foundation-model company, to work toward a CA-focused LLM - no product has shipped from that yet, but the direction is clear.

THE ICAI AI STACK, AS OF SEPTEMBER 2026

CA GPT (ai.icai.org) - a free suite of more than 70 specialised GPTs for members, logged in with your membership number: Accounting Standards, Auditing and Assurance, Direct Taxes, GST and Indirect Taxes, Ethics, annual-report analysis and more, grounded on ICAI's own publications. Use it for standards and ethics queries before a general chatbot.

ICAI Prompt Library (ai.icai.org) - member-contributed prompts by category, including Indirect Tax and GST.

AICA Level 1 - the 3-day certificate course on AI for CAs (about Rs. 5,000 + GST). Over 850 batches have run; more than 45,000 members trained.

AICA Level 2 - the 5-day blended advanced course (about Rs. 10,000 + GST). The 100th batch runs in Pune in October 2026.

AICA Level 3 - the advanced certification for Level 2 pass-outs, launched at ICAI's AI Innovation Summit 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, 26 June 2026.

For students - the AURA programme, with AURA 2.0 in preparation for practical AI in finance, audit and taxation; and a full curriculum review (the CRET committee) that reported in September 2026 to bring AI, data analytics, ESG and forensic audit into the CA course itself.

So why this playbook? Because none of that teaches the daily discipline. Courses teach what AI is; CA GPT answers questions; the prompt library gives scattered examples. What a small firm actually needs is a working set of prompts, pre-loaded with the safety rules, mapped to the workflows you run every month - GST close, notices, audit, client mail. That is what the next 60 pages are.

What AI tools cannot do, and this playbook will not pretend otherwise. A general chatbot has no connection to the GST or income-tax portals, cannot read your Tally or Zoho Books data, and cannot file anything. It handles the words; connected tools handle the data work; the Chartered Accountant owns every judgement and every sign-off.

PART 2

The Ten Rules That Keep You Out of Trouble

These rules appear, in shorter form, inside every prompt in this playbook. They exist because the documented failure mode of general AI in Indian tax work is specific: it invents section numbers, cites circulars that do not exist, and ships stale Finance Act numbers - fluently. A wrong citation in a reply to the department is worse than no citation at all.

1. Never paste identifiers.

No PAN, GSTIN, Aadhaar, bank account numbers, client names paired with figures, or draft orders with identifiers. Replace with 'a manufacturing company in Maharashtra with interstate sales'.

2. Pin the law, the period, the year.

Every prompt states: jurisdiction India, the return period or tax year, and that you are working under the Income-tax Act, 2025 (in force from 1 April 2026) or the CGST framework as it stands now. Unpinned prompts return US-flavoured, outdated answers.

3. Ask for structure, not conclusions.

Prefer 'list the checks' and 'draft the reply skeleton' over 'decide for me'. The interpretive position is yours.

4. Force [VERIFY] markers.

Instruct: 'Do not invent any section, rule, notification, circular or case citation; where one is needed, write [VERIFY].' Then resolve or delete every marker before the document moves.

5. Verify every number.

Rates, thresholds and due dates live on the portals and in the current notifications, not in the model's memory. Open the source.

6. Juniors draft, seniors verify, partners own.

Treat AI output like an articulated assistant's first draft: reviewer and sign-off noted, same as any working paper.

7. Keep the trail.

Save the prompt theme, the draft and who reviewed it in the engagement folder. ICAI's own guidance on AI-assisted audit work expects documentation of what was AI-assisted.

8. Respect the DPDP Act.

Client personal data going into a consumer chatbot is a data-protection exposure for the firm. Anonymise by default; use enterprise or no-training arrangements for sensitive work.

9. One escalation trigger.

The moment the model states a section number or rate with confidence you cannot verify, stop that thread and check the bare Act. Do not soften a wrong citation - delete it.

10. The seal stays with you.

No AI output is client-facing until a member of the firm has read all of it. Nothing in this playbook changes your professional responsibility by one rupee.

Print Rule 4 on the wall next to every workstation that touches AI. It is the single habit that separates a useful assistant from a liability.

PART 3

The Formula Behind All 60 Prompts

Every prompt in this playbook is built from five parts. Learn the pattern once and you can write your own for any situation the book does not cover.

Part	What goes in it	Example fragment
1. Role	Who the AI is for this task	'You are a GST reviewer at an Indian CA firm'
2. Task	One deliverable, in one sentence	'Build a triage table from the exceptions I paste'
3. Context	Jurisdiction, period, client type	'India, monthly GST, mid-size trader, September 2026 period'
4. Data	Anonymised facts, pasted or bracketed	'[anonymised: 3 invoices missing on portal]'
5. Format + guardrails	Output shape plus the safety lines	'Columns: type, cause, action, owner, deadline. No section numbers - write [VERIFY]'

THE GUARDRAIL BLOCK - PASTE THIS AT THE END OF ANY PROMPT

Jurisdiction: India. Period: [return period / tax year]. Do not invent any section, rule, notification, circular or case citation; where one is needed, write [VERIFY]. If you are unsure, say so instead of guessing. This output is a draft for review by a Chartered Accountant, not final advice.

Chapters follow the rhythm of practice: GST close first (it comes every month), then notices, then income tax under the new Act, then audit season, then the client and staff work that fills the rest of the week.

CHAPTER 1 - PROMPTS 01-12

GST Monthly Close under GST 2.0 and IMS

The monthly GST cycle you learned no longer exists. Since the 56th GST Council on 3 September 2025, rates were rationalised into a largely 5% and 18% structure with the 12% slab withdrawn for most goods (GST 2.0). Since April 2026, the Invoice Management System (IMS) is mandatory: every inward invoice must be accepted, rejected or kept pending, and an invoice left untouched is deemed accepted when GSTR-2B generates on the 14th. GSTR-3B's outward-tax table auto-populates from GSTR-1 and cannot be edited in 3B - the only mid-period correction window is GSTR-1A, between filing GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B. GSTN has also issued an IMS Offline Tool (from 21 April 2026) for bulk Excel review, a re-compute interest option for GSTR-3B Table 5.1, and risk-based 90% provisional refunds for eligible zero-rated claims since 1 October 2025. The 57th GST Council meets on 7 October 2026 - expect registration, ITC and refund process changes to keep coming.

These 12 prompts run that cycle. Before each, verify portal behaviour in the current GSTN advisory - GSTN has revised advisories through 2026.

PROMPT 01 | IMS exception triage table

Every month, before the 14th, when the invoice-management dashboard has a pile of exceptions.

"You are a GST reviewer at an Indian CA firm. I will paste a list of anonymised invoice-management exceptions (not in books / not in portal / amount differs / GSTIN mismatch / possible duplicate). Build a triage table with columns: exception type, likely cause, first action, owner (client team or our team), deadline relative to the 14th of the month. Sort by risk to input-tax credit. Do not cite any rule or section; where a legal reference would appear, write [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 02 | GSTR-2B vs purchase register classification

After downloading GSTR-2B, when the reconciliation throws up dozens of mismatch lines.

"Act as a GST reconciliation assistant for an Indian trading client. Given the anonymised mismatch summary I paste, classify each line as: missing in books, missing in GSTR-2B, taxable-value difference, tax difference, probable round-off, or probable amendment. For each class give the standard follow-up step in one line and mark whether it needs supplier action or a books correction. No statutory citations; use [VERIFY] where a section number would go."

PROMPT 03 | Supplier ITC chase email sequence

When suppliers have not reported your client's invoices and credit is stuck.

"Draft a 3-step escalation email sequence to a supplier who has not reported our client's invoices for [month]. Step 1: polite reminder with the invoice list. Step 2: firm follow-up noting the client's credit is blocked and interest risk is building. Step 3: final notice before the client withholds payment. Replace every legal reference with [VERIFY]. Professional Indian business English, short paragraphs, under 120 words each."

PROMPT 04 | Post-GST-2.0 rate sanity check

When a client's supplier invoices look off after the rate rationalisation.

"Here is an anonymised client item list with GST rates and HSN codes as billed by suppliers. After the September 2025 GST 2.0 rate rationalisation to a mainly 5% / 18% structure, flag items whose billed rate looks inconsistent with that structure. Do not state the correct rate with certainty - mark each flag 'verify against the current notification for this HSN' and list the evidence to obtain. Do not invent notification numbers."

PROMPT 05 | Monthly GST close checklist

Standardise the month-end routine across clients so juniors run it without you.

"Act as a CA practice manager. Draft a monthly GST close checklist for a mid-size trading client with monthly GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B. Cover: purchase-register freeze date, invoice-management-system review before the 14th, GSTR-2B download and reconciliation, GSTR-1 preparation, the GSTR-1A correction window before GSTR-3B, 3B review points, and cash-vs-credit ledger check. One line per item as a tick-box. No circular or section numbers - mark [VERIFY] where needed."

PROMPT 06 | GSTR-1 pre-filing verification list

The 20 minutes before you file GSTR-1, every period, every client.

"I am filing GSTR-1 for [period] for an anonymised client. Create a pre-filing verification list covering: B2B vs B2C split, e-way bill linkage, credit and debit notes, exports with and without payment of tax, amendments to earlier periods, and HSN summary reconciliation with the sales register. One line per check naming the evidence that supports it. Use [VERIFY] instead of any legal reference."

PROMPT 07 | Client explainer: why credit was reversed

The WhatsApp message you owe a director when this month's 3B shows a reversal.

"Write a plain-English, WhatsApp-ready note (under 150 words) to a client director explaining why some input tax credit was reversed this month. Facts I will give you: [anonymised - e.g., 3 supplier invoices missing on the portal, one rate change]. Do not blame any party, cite no law, and end with the two actions the client must take."

PROMPT 08 | IMS standard operating procedure for a client

Hand this to the client's in-house accountant so they stop phoning your office.

"Draft a one-page standard operating procedure for a client's in-house accountant for the GST portal's invoice management system. Cover: what IMS is (one sentence), the three actions (accept, reject, pending) and when to use each, the 14th-of-the-month deadline and the deemed-acceptance consequence, what to do with credit notes, and a 5-line monthly workflow. Simple English, no legal citations."

PROMPT 09 | ITC-at-risk tracker design

A standing register so reversal risk is visible weekly, not discovered at filing.

"Create a tracker format (spreadsheet columns, status values, review cadence) for monitoring invoices at risk of credit reversal because suppliers have not reported them, with follow-up ageing buckets of 0-15, 16-30, 31-60 and 60+ days. Add a one-line definition for each column and guidance on when to escalate to the partner. Do not include statutory timelines; mark them [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 10 | Monthly compliance health report

The half-page summary management actually reads, instead of a 40-row dump.

"Act as a GST practice head. I will paste anonymised month-end figures for a client (filing dates, mismatch counts, pending IMS items, credit reversed). Draft a half-page management review with: three things going well, three risks ranked by impact, and two decisions needed from management. Neutral tone, no adjectives next to numbers."

PROMPT 11 | Client notice-risk scorecard

Use at onboarding and before every annual review - cheap prevention.

"Build a 12-question self-assessment scorecard that rates an SME client's GST notice risk across recurring 2B mismatches, late filings, rate errors after GST 2.0, supplier defaults, e-way bill gaps and credit-note handling. Score 1-5 each, with thresholds for low / medium / high. No legal references; mark [VERIFY] where needed."

PROMPT 12 | Supplier GST onboarding checklist

New vendor, new risk - check before the first invoice is booked.

"Draft a supplier GST onboarding checklist for a client: documents to collect (registration certificate copy, bank details, authorised signatory), verification steps on the portal (active status, filing-history indicator, name and GSTIN match), and red flags to reject or hold. One line per item. Add a short paragraph on why this protects the client's credit."

CHAPTER 2 - PROMPTS 13-19

GST Notices and Show-Cause Replies

Notice work is where AI temptation is strongest - short response windows, a blank page, and a model that will happily produce something that reads like a reply in thirty seconds. 'Reads like a reply' and 'is defensible' are different things. The prompts below use AI only for the carpentry: para-wise summarising, skeleton drafting, timelines and tracking. Every citation stays yours.

PROMPT 13 | Scrutiny notice (ASMT-10) summary and reply skeleton

Day one of a scrutiny notice - before panic, before drafting.

"I have received a GST scrutiny notice (ASMT-10 type) for an anonymised client. First, summarise the notice para by para: what is alleged, what is asked, by when. Then outline a reply skeleton with headings only - facts, reconciliation, documents relied on, prayer - and leave all legal grounds blank with [VERIFY] placeholders. Do not draft substantive law."

PROMPT 14 | Demand intimation (DRC-01A) response plan

When the intimation precedes the formal show cause and you still have room to respond.

"Given this anonymised demand intimation (DRC-01A type) alleging [theme], draft a structured response plan: timeline of the issue, evidence to gather from the client, points where a personal hearing should be requested, and a risk table (allegation / evidence strength / exposure if unaddressed). No citations; use [VERIFY]. The CA adds all law."

PROMPT 15 | Show-cause theme triage and common mistakes

Before you start writing - know the shape of the battlefield.

"For an anonymised show-cause notice on [ITC mismatch / e-way bill / valuation], list the standard sections such replies usually cover as a checklist with one line on the evidence each needs. Mark every section reference [VERIFY] - do not fill in numbers. Then list the top five mistakes CAs make in such replies so I can review against them."

PROMPT 16 | E-way bill allegation reply structure

Detention cases: facts first, chronology always.

"Draft the paragraph structure for a reply to an e-way bill detention allegation for an anonymised client: facts timeline, vehicle and document chronology, submission of delivery evidence, request for release, and prayer. Headings only - I will insert verified facts and law. Mark all statutory references [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 17 | Notice deadline extraction and countdown

The limitation clock is a professional duty no tool will discharge for you.

"From the notice text I paste (anonymised), extract every date that matters: issue date, response due date, alleged tax period, any hearing date. Then produce a reverse-countdown action plan for our team working back from the response due date - client information to collect, drafting, internal review, partner sign-off, buffer. Do not compute any statutory limitation - flag dates I must confirm with [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 18 | Appeal versus compliance decision memo

When the client asks 'should we fight this?' - give options, not an answer.

"Create a decision memo outline for a client deciding whether to appeal a GST order: facts, amount in dispute, pre-deposit consideration (mark the percentage [VERIFY]), alternative compliance routes, timeline, and a pros-cons table. One line per item. Neutral - it must read as options for discussion, not a recommendation."

PROMPT 19 | Firm-wide notice tracking register

Because the notice you forgot is the notice that costs the most.

"Design a firm-wide GST notice tracking register: field list (client, notice type, received date, due date, owner, status, next action, closure evidence), status values, and a 15-minute weekly review agenda for the team. Add rules for when a notice must be escalated to the partner the same day."

CHAPTER 3 - PROMPTS 20-29

Income Tax under the Act, 2025

The Income-tax Act, 1961 was repealed on 1 April 2026 and replaced by the Income-tax Act, 2025 (as amended by the Finance Act, 2026) - a consolidated Act with renumbered sections, renamed forms and the new 'tax year' language. Your tax did not change; every number you quote did. This makes AI dangerous here in a specific way: models trained mostly on the old Act happily cite dead section numbers. Every prompt below pins the new Act and forces [VERIFY] on numbering.

PROMPT 20 | Old-to-new section mapping (with a trap detector)

You know the old number; the client file and your muscle memory are still in 1961-speak.

"Under the Income-tax Act, 2025, in force from 1 April 2026, map the old section numbers I list to their new equivalents and give one line on what changed in each beyond renumbering. Where you are not certain of the new number, write [VERIFY] - do not guess. The new Act uses 'tax year' instead of assessment year; flag every place my question mixes old and new terminology."

PROMPT 21 | Salaried return review checklist

Every individual return before it goes out, every filing season.

"Create a review checklist for a salaried client's return under the new Act: income heads, exemptions and deductions (new numbering), TDS credit vs statements, advance tax position, and a final sanity list (PAN, bank details, form type). Mark section references [VERIFY]. One line per item."

PROMPT 22 | Statement mismatch triage (AIS / passbook)

The pre-filing ritual: books vs the department's view of the client.

"I will paste anonymised mismatches between the client's books and the annual information / tax passbook statements. Classify each as: timing difference, missing income, duplicate reporting, statement error, or needs client confirmation. For each class give the standard resolution step in one line. No legal citations."

PROMPT 23 | TDS default notice workflow

For the client who forwarded a TDS intimation at 9 pm.

"Draft a workflow for handling a TDS default intimation for an anonymised client: documents to pull, the correction-versus-justification decision points, and a client communication draft explaining next steps in simple English without admitting any default. [VERIFY] for all section numbers."

PROMPT 24 | Capital versus revenue arguments memo

The classic judgement call - get both sides on paper before you decide.

"For the facts I describe ([anonymised transaction]), list the arguments for treating the payment as capital expenditure and as revenue expenditure, with the factors an assessing officer would weigh. Do not conclude - end with 'factors for the CA to weigh'. No case law, no section numbers; use [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 25 | New client tax onboarding questionnaire

First meeting structure that covers what matters, in order.

"Create a structured onboarding questionnaire for a new individual tax client: income sources, investments, existing filings, foreign assets, business interests, family profile for planning, and documents to collect at stage 1 versus stage 2. Group questions by topic with a one-line why for each group."

PROMPT 26 | Advance tax explainer for a client

Explaining without citing - because the rate is yours to fill, not the model's.

"Write a plain-English explainer (under 200 words) for a client on how advance tax works, why instalments matter, and the consequence of underpayment - without citing any section or interest rate. Mark interest rates as [VERIFY] and tell me the two figures I must fill from current law before sending."

PROMPT 27 | Filing-season status email

When the file is stuck because the client's documents are stuck.

"Draft a short, warm status email to a client whose return preparation is delayed because their documents are incomplete: what is done, what is pending, exactly what I need, and by when. Offer two time slots for a call. No legal references."

PROMPT 28 | Deduction claim - three-views note

The client 'knows' it is deductible. The officer will not. Write both.

"For the deduction the client wants to claim ([anonymised type]), draft a one-page note in three parts: the claim as the client sees it, the sceptical assessing officer's view, and the questions that decide which view wins. No conclusions, no section numbers - mark [VERIFY] where the law must be inserted."

PROMPT 29 | Delayed refund escalation letter

Polite persistence, structured.

"Draft a polite escalation letter to the jurisdictional officer for a delayed refund for an anonymised client (return filed [date], no intimation yet): facts table, request for status, and request to expedite. Leave all statutory references as [VERIFY]. Professional, firm, short."

CHAPTER 4 - PROMPTS 30-39

Audit, Form 3CD and CARO 2020

Audit is where AI output must behave like a working paper: structured, checkable, and never concluding on your behalf. These prompts produce skeletons, indexes, grids and letters - the monotonous 40% of audit season. The opinion, the sampling judgement and the sign-off never leave the engagement team. Keep an AI-assistance log alongside the file (Prompt 39 gives you the checklist) - ICAI's documentation expectations for AI-assisted audit work make the trail itself part of the paper.

PROMPT 30 | Audit planning memo outline

First week of every statutory audit engagement.

"Draft an audit planning memo outline for a mid-size Indian manufacturing company: engagement scope, understanding of the entity, risk areas, materiality approach (with a [VERIFY] placeholder for the computed figure), planned procedures by cycle, team allocation, and timeline. Two lines per heading maximum. Mark standards references [VERIFY SA] - do not fill in numbers."

PROMPT 31 | Business and control-environment questions

First-year client: understand before you test.

"Generate 30 questions for understanding a first-year audit client's business and control environment, grouped into industry, operations, financing, IT systems, related parties, and prior-year history. Each question must be answerable in one line by the client. No standards citations."

PROMPT 32 | Sampling rationale template

The working paper reviewers ask for and juniors hate writing.

"Draft a sampling rationale working-paper template: objective, population definition, sampling method, sample size basis, selection approach, exceptions found, and conclusion structure. Leave statistical parameters blank for the auditor to fill. Mark standards references [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 33 | Form 3CD clause evidence map

Tax audit, clause group by clause group.

"Create a working-paper index that maps each tax audit (Form 3CD) clause group to the evidence typically needed, split into 'data' versus 'judgement' items, for a [trading / manufacturing] client. Mark clause numbers as [VERIFY] - I will insert current numbering. One line per clause group."

PROMPT 34 | CARO 2020 reporting grid*The paragraph-by-paragraph grind, pre-structured.*

"Build a CARO 2020 reporting grid for a manufacturing client: clause theme, standard response wording style, evidence to obtain, and common exceptions. Keep the wording column as style guidance only, not final report language. Mark clause references [VERIFY]."

PROMPT 35 | Management letter from exceptions*Turn a verified exception list into the letter without softening it.*

"Turn the following verified exception list (I will paste) into a management letter structure: observation, criteria, cause, effect, recommendation - without softening or dramatising any finding. Group by process area. No statutory references."

PROMPT 36 | Key audit matter / emphasis paragraph draft*Reporting language, ready for partner editing.*

"Draft a key audit matters / emphasis of matter paragraph in reporting language for this anonymised matter: [describe]. Structure: why the matter was significant, how the audit addressed it, and cross-reference points to the notes. Mark standards references [VERIFY]. It must read as a draft for partner editing, not final language."

PROMPT 37 | Tax audit file index and version rules*So any reviewer can find any paper in two minutes.*

"Design a filing index (folder tree plus naming convention) for a tax audit engagement file: planning, programme, evidence by clause, client representations, review notes, and an AI-assistance log noting which drafts were AI-assisted and who reviewed them. One line per folder. Include version-control rules in 3 lines."

PROMPT 38 | Governance communication agenda*The discussion before the report - run it like a meeting, not a surprise.*

"Draft an agenda and talking points for the pre-finalisation discussion with those charged with governance: significant matters, misstatements summary, going concern, management representations needed, and timeline. Two lines per item, neutral tone."

PROMPT 39 | AI-assisted working paper QA checklist*The gate every AI-touched paper passes before it enters the file.*

"Create a 15-point quality review checklist for any AI-assisted working paper: anonymisation verified, [VERIFY] markers resolved or removed, no invented citations, figures reconciled to source, reviewer noted, and documentation of which tool was used. One line per check."

CHAPTER 5 - PROMPTS 40-47

Client Communication

Writing emails is not billable, but it is where clients form their view of the firm. These prompts handle the recurring ones - fee follow-ups, expectation-setting, explainers - in a tone that is warm but firm, in Indian business English. As always: replace the bracketed placeholders, anonymise any facts, and read before sending.

PROMPT 40 | Fee reminder email sequence*The three-email arc from gentle to final.*

"Draft a 3-email fee reminder sequence for a long-standing client: gentle reminder; second notice stating the total and due date; final notice offering a call before escalation. Warm but firm, Indian business English, each under 120 words. Do not mention legal action in the first two."

PROMPT 41 | Final follow-up on unpaid invoices

Two invoices, months old, one professional message.

"Write a final fee follow-up email to a client with two unpaid invoices ([anonymised amounts, months]): state the facts, offer a payment plan or a call, and give a clear last date. Respectful, no threats, under 130 words."

PROMPT 42 | New client welcome email

Start the relationship with clarity, not a wall of text.

"Draft a welcome email for a new client with a subject line, what happens next, a document checklist placeholder for me to fill, how we communicate, and turn-around expectations. Warm, professional, under 180 words."

PROMPT 43 | Plain-English explainer of a technical schedule

For the director who asks 'so what does this mean?'

"Rewrite this verified computation schedule (I will paste it) in plain English for a client director with no finance background. Do not change any number. Mark any sentence that needs the CA to confirm before sending. Keep it under 200 words with a 3-line summary at the end."

PROMPT 44 | Out-of-scope work pushback

Scope creep arrives politely; decline it politely.

"Draft a polite email declining additional out-of-scope work ([anonymised request]) while offering a paid add-on option: what the current engagement covers, why this sits outside it, and the cost and timeline if they want it added. Under 140 words, no legalese."

PROMPT 45 | Peak-season expectations notice

One notice, two formats, saves a hundred phone calls.

"Draft a client-facing notice setting expectations for the [tax season / GST deadline] period: response times, document cut-off dates, best ways to reach us, and what counts as urgent. Give an email version and a WhatsApp version. Friendly, crystal clear, short."

PROMPT 46 | Monthly client newsletter template

The discipline that keeps clients all year, not just at deadlines.

"Create a monthly client newsletter template with three sections: a compliance deadline table (blank for me to fill), one short educational piece (under 120 words), and one firm update slot. Include three subject-line options. No legal citations anywhere."

PROMPT 47 | Fee-increase conversation notes

The discussion every partner postpones - prepare it once.

"Prepare talking points for a partner discussing a fee increase with a long-term client: how to open, what to cite (scope growth, quality, turnaround), what to concede, and two exit options if the client resists. Bullet points only, no scripts that sound robotic."

CHAPTER 6 - PROMPTS 48-60

Practice, People and Training

The chapter that pays compound interest. Templates that make juniors productive in week one, a firm AI policy you can adopt tomorrow, Excel routines for Tally exports, and the training curriculum that turns AI from a partner's toy into the office's method.

PROMPT 48 | Engagement letter outline

Before any new work starts - scope in writing.

"Draft an engagement letter outline for [service type]: scope, deliverables, timelines, fee and billing terms, client responsibilities, confidentiality, limitation of liability, and termination. Two lines per heading; leave all statutory references and form numbers as [VERIFY]. I will adapt to the firm's template."

PROMPT 49 | Four-week AI training curriculum for article assistants

Onboarding that sticks - with a pass/fail rubric.

"Design a 4-week training curriculum for new article assistants on using AI safely in office work: week 1 - basics and anonymisation drills; week 2 - drafting with [VERIFY] discipline; week 3 - GST and audit workflows from our SOPs; week 4 - a supervised live task with review criteria. Include a pass/fail review rubric."

PROMPT 50 | One-page firm AI usage policy

Adopt at tomorrow's team meeting. Ten clauses.

"Write a one-page AI usage policy for a small CA firm: an approved-tools list placeholder; what may never be pasted into consumer AI (PAN, GSTIN, full financials, names paired with data); the [VERIFY] rule; the review hierarchy (assistant drafts, senior verifies, partner owns); and an escalation path when the AI invents a citation. Plain English, 10 short clauses."

PROMPT 51 | Task briefing template for delegation

Delegation fails at the briefing, not the execution.

"Create a task briefing template for delegating work to article assistants: objective in one line, inputs, steps, output format, review points, deadline, and common mistakes to avoid. Keep it under 12 lines so it actually gets used."

PROMPT 52 | Interview questions for junior hires

Hire for sense, not software knowledge.

"Give me 10 interview questions for hiring article assistants that test basic accounting sense, attention to detail, communication, and willingness to use AI carefully. Mark each with what a good answer contains and what a red-flag answer sounds like."

PROMPT 53 | Monthly team review agenda

Thirty minutes, once a month, per person.

"Draft a 30-minute monthly review agenda for each team member: wins, misses, workload, one skill to build, and one process improvement suggestion. Include the three questions a reviewer should ask to make it a conversation, not an interrogation."

PROMPT 54 | Excel formula helper for reconciliation

Tally export meets portal CSV - the formulae, explained.

"You are an Excel expert for an Indian CA office. I have [describe the reconciliation task - e.g., matching a Tally sales export to a portal GSTR-1 CSV]. Suggest the exact formulae (XLOOKUP or INDEX-MATCH, IFERROR, SUMIFS) using the column letters I give you, and explain each formula in one line so juniors learn. Do not assume my data is clean - start with the three most common data-cleanup steps."

PROMPT 55 | Tally export cleanup routine*The five steps before any match will work.*

"Give me a step-by-step Excel cleanup routine for a raw Tally export before reconciliation: trim spaces, split GSTIN state codes, date formatting, handling blank cells, duplicate check, and a control total. One line per step with the menu path or formula."

PROMPT 56 | Firm knowledge base structure*Stop answering the same question twice.*

"Design a firm knowledge base structure: folders for clients, taxes (GST, income tax), audit, templates, SOPs, AI prompts that worked, and training. Give a naming convention and five rules to keep it alive. Under one page."

PROMPT 57 | Client offboarding process*End engagements as professionally as you start them.*

"Draft a client offboarding process: handover of documents, final billing clarity, data retention and return of records (mark the retention period [VERIFY]), an internal closure checklist, and a polite closure email template."

PROMPT 58 | Practice niche analysis for the partner*Where the firm should point its next 12 months.*

"Analyse these anonymised facts about my town's business profile (I will paste: main industries, competitor firm count, my team's strengths) and rank three practice niches for our firm to develop over 12 months, with what each needs: skills, tools, pricing approach, and first three steps. Read as a draft for partner discussion, not a decision."

PROMPT 59 | Twelve-month team upskilling plan*One theme a month, CPE-friendly.*

"Build a 12-month upskilling plan for a small firm's team around AI: one theme per month (prompting discipline, GST automation, audit analytics, data privacy under the DPDP Act, and so on), each with a free resource type to find, a practice assignment, and a measure of progress. Three lines per month."

PROMPT 60 | Weekly follow-up summary from rough notes*Friday evening, ten minutes, the whole week sorted.*

"I will paste my rough weekly client notes (abbreviated, anonymised). Produce: a follow-up table (client, pending item, owner, next date), a three-line summary for the partner, and a list of anything that looks like it needs escalation. Do not invent details that are not in my notes; mark unclear items 'confirm'."

PART 4

Which Tool for Which Job

Most firms that say 'AI did not work for us' asked a chatbot to do an audit, or expected an audit engine to write their client newsletters. Run a small stack instead - one general assistant, ICAI's free member tools, and a connected engine only when real data demands it.

Job	Use	Why
Drafting, emails, checklists, structure	A general assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)	The words layer - with this playbook's rules
Standards, ethics, ICAI-guidance queries	CA GPT on ai.icaai.org (free for members)	Grounded on ICAI's own publications
Cited Indian tax and GST research	A India-law corpus tool (Taxmann-type research suites)	Citations you can open and verify
GSTR-2B / purchase-register matching at scale	A books-connected GST suite (reads Tally / Zoho Books)	A chatbot cannot read your ledgers
Statutory / tax audit execution	An audit-native engine, or your existing audit stack	Working-paper trails and evidence
Judgement, interpretation, sign-off	The Chartered Accountant	Never delegated - to any tool

Cost discipline. A paid general assistant runs a few thousand rupees a seat each month; GST and audit suites scale with client count and engagement volume. Start with the free member tools and one assistant; add a connected engine only when the manual hours you are losing justify it. Re-check prices with the vendor before budgeting - they change.

Data-handling discipline. For anything touching client data, read the vendor's data-retention and training terms first, and prefer enterprise or no-training arrangements. The DPDP Act makes 'we always did it this way' a poor defence.

PART 5

The 30-Day Firm Adoption Plan

Do not roll AI out to the whole office on Monday. Run this plan on one workflow, with one junior, for one month - then expand what works.

Days 1-5

Pick one recurring pain - the monthly IMS triage or the vendor ITC chase. Run Prompts 01-03 yourself on real (anonymised) work. Note the minutes saved.

Days 6-10

Write the one-page firm AI policy (Prompt 50). Adopt it at a team meeting. Put the [VERIFY] rule on the wall.

Days 11-20

Train one junior on Prompts 01-09 with the anonymisation drill. Review every output they produce. Log what the AI got wrong - that log becomes your training material.

Days 21-27

Extend to one drafting workflow (Chapter 5) and one audit skeleton (Chapter 4). Build the knowledge-base folder for prompts that worked (Prompt 56).

Days 28-30

Measure: hours saved per month, errors caught in review, junior confidence. Decide the next workflow to add - and whether a connected tool is now justified.

THE ONE-LINE SUMMARY OF THIS BOOK

AI drafts; you verify; the portal and the bare Act are always the truth; the sign-off is always yours - and with the right prompts, the drafting is no longer your evening.

QUICK REFERENCE

One Page to Keep on Your Desk

Situation	Prompt numbers
IMS exceptions pile up before the 14th	01, 02, 08, 09
Supplier has not reported invoices	03, 09, 12
Rate looks wrong after GST 2.0	04, 11
Scrutiny or show-cause notice arrives	13, 14, 15, 16, 17
Client deciding on an appeal	18
Notice deadlines across clients	19, 60
Old section number, new Act	20
Return filing season	21, 22, 26, 27
Capital vs revenue call	24, 28
Tax audit season	30-38
Fee recovery	40, 41, 47
New client	12, 25, 42
Juniors and training	49, 51, 52, 55
Firm systems	48, 50, 53, 56, 57, 59

THE GUARDRAIL BLOCK, AGAIN - IT IS THAT IMPORTANT

Jurisdiction: India. Period: [return period / tax year]. Do not invent any section, rule, notification, circular or case citation; where one is needed, write [VERIFY]. If you are unsure, say so instead of guessing. This output is a draft for review by a Chartered Accountant, not final advice.

Sources for everything stated as fact in this book (verified 30 September 2026): ai.icai.org (CA GPT, prompt library, AICA course pages); icai.org (AI Innovation Summit 2026 post, 26 June 2026); Indian Express, 25 September 2026 (AICA batch counts, AURA 2.0, curriculum review); gst.gov.in portal FAQs and GSTN advisories, including the IMS FAQ for the October 2025 tax period; the Income-tax Act, 2025 (as amended by the Finance Act, 2026) on incometaxindia.gov.in. Where the book says 'verify', verify.

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